The same pattern has been visible for much longer in Iran, ever since the Imam Khomeini overthrew the Shah in 1979, putting an end to the "Golden Age" of the 80,00-strong Persian Jewish community, as well as the close ties of Iran with Israel. Khomeini's antisemitism was always fiercely ideological, closely linked to his hatred for America, Israel, and the Shah of Iran. Zionism for him (and his successors) was the creed of a ciminal, satanic, "usuroer regime" whose domination of Palestine and Jerusalem (*Quds*) represented an intolerable affront to Islam. the liberation of Palestine and Israel's annihilation were turned by Khomeini and his successors into central elements in the revival of the honor, glory, and greatness of Islam—to be led by a revolutionary "anti-imperialist" Shi'ite Iran. Today, Iran has de facto become the dominant expansionist power in the Gulf, the Levan, and much of the Middle East. The call to liquidate Israel still remains in place.

The long-standing ruler of Iran, the Supreme Guide Imam Khamenei, has also never lost an opportunity to demonize the Jewish State, not only as a blackmailer, but as a "deadly cancer" whose presence had enabled the world's "arrogant powers" (especially America) to dominate and exploit the Muslim world. Only a year ago, Khamenei once again referred to Israel and the "rabid dog in the region," describing its leaders as "beasts who cannot be called human." This dehumanizing terminology underpins the Iranian leadership's constant refrain that "Israel must be wiped out." According to the prevailing Islamist ideology of Iran and its Lebanese Shi'ite ally, Hezbollah (largely an Iranian creation), the "Jewish-Zionist tumor" in the Middle East must be surgically removed if peace is to be restored to the region. This was also the position of the Egyptian Muslim Brotherhood and its offshoots like Hamas.[6]

Not surprisingly, Iran's radical antisemitic ideology, along with public denail of the Holocaust, has attracted many Western neo-Nazis and European negationists. There is a long list of repulsive Western Holocaust deniers—including Roger Garaudy, Robert Faurisson, Mark Weber, Frederick Toben, Jürgen Graf, and Ernst Zündel who admire Iran or have made the pilgrimage to Tehran.[7] There are also a number of well-known revolutionary leftists who have identified with Iran's posturings as a militant defender of Palestine and supporter of the "oppressed masses" throughout the Third World. Both Iran and the Lebanese Hezbollah have enjoyed enthusiastic support from prominent leftist politicians including the late Venezuelan head of state, Hugo Chávez, his successor Nicolas Maduro, and the Nicaraguan leader Daniel Ortega—all of them Marxist socialists and close Latin American allies of Iran's theocratic regime. Hezbollah has also been hailed as a "socially progressive" movement by a number of strongly anti-Zionist American

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